HOOK

# Everyone demos agents. Nobody shows the wiring.

A 600+ comment HN thread just proved people are done with demos.

- They want real configs, not polished output clips
- Same question repeated: what does your setup actually look like
- That question is the whole industry right now

WHAT'S HAPPENING

# The hype phase is ending, the comparison phase started

Builders are publishing actual architecture breakdowns instead of highlight reels.

- Detailed writeups on coordination and state are gaining traction
- HN megathread is practitioners comparing real stacks
- Signal: people trust implementation detail over demo videos

THE MECHANICS

# Multi-agent systems break into 3 real decisions

Every setup, no matter the tools, answers these the same way.

- Coordination: one orchestrator or agents talking directly
- State: shared memory or isolated context per agent
- Tool routing: who decides which tool gets called

PATTERN 1

# Orchestrator-worker is the most common setup

One agent plans, breaks down the task, and assigns pieces.

- Workers stay narrow and don't need to know the full goal
- Easier to debug because failures trace back to one planner
- Downside: orchestrator becomes a bottleneck under load

PATTERN 2

# Peer-to-peer agents sound cool, cost more to run

Agents message each other directly without a central planner.

- Useful when tasks genuinely need back and forth negotiation
- Harder to trace why a decision happened
- Most teams on the thread said they regretted starting here

STATE HANDLING

# Shared memory is where most systems actually break

This is the part demos never show because it isn't visual.

- Shared state causes agents to overwrite each other's work
- Isolated context avoids conflict but duplicates information
- Most stable setups log state changes instead of sharing live memory

TOOL ROUTING

# Decide who picks the tool before you decide the tools

This is the design choice that determines how much breaks later.

- Central router: one agent owns every tool call
- Delegated routing: each agent owns its own tool access
- Delegated routing scales better but needs stricter guardrails

TAKEAWAY

# Pick the pattern before you pick the model

The framework and the LLM are the easy decisions.

- Decide coordination style first: orchestrator or peer-to-peer
- Decide state handling second: shared or isolated
- Decide tool routing last, once the first two are settled

CTA

# What does your actual agent setup look like?

Not the pitch version. The real one.

- Orchestrator, peer-to-peer, or something in between?
- I'm comparing real configs, drop yours in the comments

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